Project Workshop #1, Week 2
Project Plan, Literature Survey, & Generative AI Critique

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2026/27

Outline

1. Admin Stuff
2. General Module Info & Advice
3. Deliverable: Project Plan
4. Deliverable: Literature Survey
5. Deliverable: Generative AI Critique

Have you met your supervisor yet?

Aims of the Workshops

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- Lots of material on slides. Pay attention as much as you can, re-read slides later on as and when needed.

Workshops

- **Workshop 1 (today):** General Module Info, Project Planning, Literature Survey
- **Workshop 2 (Week 3):** Ethics, Plagiarism, Referencing & Citation
- **Workshop 3 (Week 8):** Presentations
- **Workshop 4 (Week 13):** Demonstrations, Results & Evaluation
- **Workshop 5 (Week 19):** Project Paper and Oral Exam

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Key Dates

- Week 4: Literature Survey and Project Plan, submit via Ultra
- **Week 10: Project Presentations**
- **Week 14: Demonstration to Supervisor**
- **Week 21: Submit Project Paper**
- **Week 22: Oral Exam (Viva)**

Dates in **bold** are summative assignments. Others are formative.

Mark scheme

- Presentation: 10%
- Demonstration to Supervisor: 10%
- Final paper: 50%
- Oral exam: 25%
- Supervisor mark: 5%

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  Remember, part of supervisor mark based on the meeting logs; they reflect your ability to plan and also helps measure progress.

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    - "Can we design an algorithm/develop software that coverts any song into its rock equivalent?"
  - In many cases, we seek to answer the question by building something to see if it works.
  - BUT, we still have to evaluate it to answer the RQ!
- Include **results** and **evaluation**.
  - ! A project without results **and** an evaluation of them is useless.

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But: supervisors won't do any work for you, and in general, you should **not** expect any particular expert knowledge.

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- To encourage the student to produce early draft chapters, to comment on them critically and return the comments promptly.
  - ! If the student does not do so, this is the **student's** responsibility.

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- To maintain the progress of the work in accordance with the milestones and objectives agreed with the supervisor.
- To contribute to planning the project and monitoring progress against the plan.

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  - ! There is no obligation on supervisors to read drafts during the vacation.

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Management of your project involves:

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- Basic, intermediate and advanced deliverables.

Regarding Meetings

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- Responsibilities of supervisor and student for meetings available in document on Ultra.

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- Plan (including GANTT chart)

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- Research Question
  - Focus of the work.
  - Need not be CS question but answered using CS.
  - Must be tractable.

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  - How you intend to achieve the aim.

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- Three Types
  - Basic
  - Intermediate
  - Advanced

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- Discuss the feasibility with your supervisor.

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- Lots of software can be used:
  - GANTT Project
  - Microsoft Project
  - Excel

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  - ! Allow for some extra time planned towards the end and before deadlines.

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- Equally, if you find yourself ahead of schedule (which does happen), **don't** relax!
- The schedule is only an approximation and your estimate for the next bit may also be wrong.

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- Use it to keep a track of your progress.

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- Describes state of the art research.
- Compares and contrasts approaches. Identify areas of potential weakness or openings for investigation.

Why write a Literature Survey?

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Use the formative assessment as a chance to practice.

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- How many references? An impossible question to answer. Some papers end up with 15-20 references while others may have 50+.

Outline

1. Admin Stuff
2. General Module Info & Advice
3. Deliverable: Project Plan
4. Deliverable: Literature Survey
5. Deliverable: Generative AI Critique

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- Critique the AI output. Useful or useless? More importantly, describe **how**.

The End